
Dating an IBM Quantum Job from Its Identifier: a Verifiable Audit

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Repository: <https://github.com/jonathanssearch/RATISS-ARCHIVES> (tools and register)

Abstract

An IBM Quantum job identifier encodes its creation date: $t = \text{base32}(\text{id}[0:9])/8192$, in seconds since the Unix epoch. Over 66 timestamped raw payloads the median gap with the server timestamp is 278 ms. 86 identifiers were inventoried over 12/08 → 23/09/2026. The finding is corroborated by four platform captures: 17/17 identical backends, timestamps agreeing within one minute, and quota accounting matching the inventory. The check requires no IBM account.

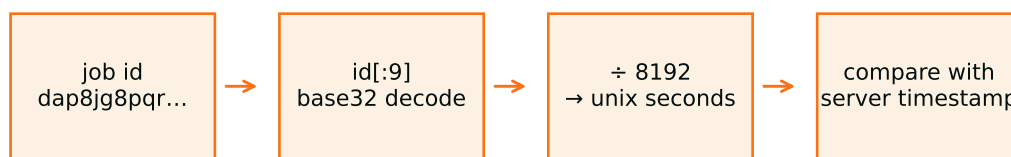
Question

Does an opaque QPU job identifier carry enough structure to date its creation, and is that dating corroborated by server-side timestamps?

Method

Base32 decoding of the first nine characters, division by 8192 → Unix seconds; comparison with server timestamps on 66 payloads; independent corroboration by platform captures and quota accounting.

SCHEMATIC — decoding pipeline, not measured data



median gap 278 ms over 66 timestamped payloads · 86 ids · 12/08 → 23/09/2026

Figure 1: Decoding pipeline from identifier to creation time. Schematic diagram, not measured data. Median gap 278 ms over 66 payloads.

Results

- Formula: $t = \text{base32}(\text{id}[0:9])/8192$ (Unix seconds).
- Median gap 278 ms against server timestamps, over 66 payloads.

- 86 identifiers inventoried, period 12/08 → 23/09/2026.
- Corroboration: 17/17 identical backends, timestamps within one minute, coherent quota.

Negative results and corrections

- d762omnq1anc738d2cj0 is NOT a job: it is the IBM documentation example.
- No ZK-STARK: certification rests on SHA-256 fingerprints (author's correction).
- Assumed divergences: `synchrotron-24/s04.json` $\lambda = 0.002$ (point on the separatrix); `continuum/c01` (sampling noise without seed).

Controls

Five tools tested; the register is rebuildable from a clone via `verifier_corpus.py`; job exports comparable via `comparer_export_ibm.py`.

Reproducibility

```
python3 outils/decode_job_id.py <job_id>
python3 outils/verifier_corpus.py
```

Limitations

The dating yields server-side creation time, not execution time; resolution limited by the 1/8192 s step.

Data and code availability

<https://github.com/jonathansearch/RATISS-ARCHIVES> — `outils/decode_jobid.py` family and `preuves/qpu/REGISTRE`
Zenodo DOI: to be assigned.

RATISS Labs — independent, single-author laboratory, Yaoundé (Cameroon). No number in this document is invented: every value carries a source in Section “Data and code availability” or in the references. Negative results are published with the same prominence as positive ones.